

Main tube is 63 ft (19.2 m) long and holds the giant glass lens, which weighs 500 lb (225 kg).

Refracting telescope at Yerkes Observatory in Wisconsin

Paths in the sky
See pages 72–73

Mount supports the main tube and helps point the telescope at different parts of the night sky.

In 1896, French physicist Henri Becquerel discovered radioactivity by chance while working with uranium salts.

1899

Aspirin goes on sale

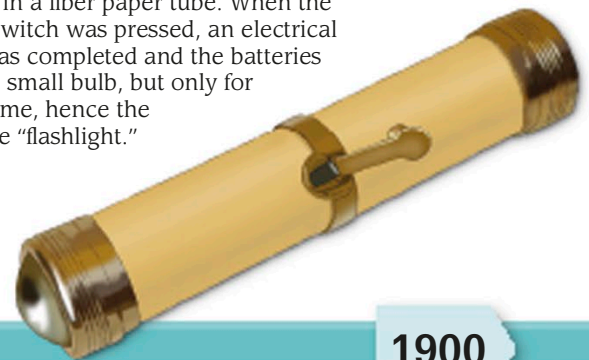
The drug acetylsalicylic acid (ASA) was developed in 1897 by the company Bayer in Germany, and was branded and sold as Aspirin from 1899. It reduced pain in the body's nerve endings and was to become the world's most common pain reliever, with more than 100 billion tablets taken every year.



1899

First flashlight

English inventor David Misell created the first tubular flashlight by enclosing three "D cell" batteries in a fiber paper tube. When the contact switch was pressed, an electrical circuit was completed and the batteries lit up the small bulb, but only for a short time, hence the nickname "flashlight."



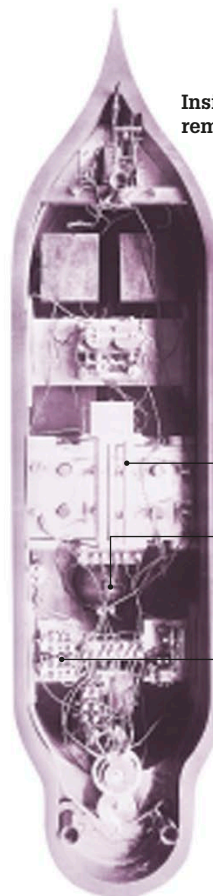
1900

1898

First remote control

Austrian-Hungarian inventor Nikola Tesla demonstrated the first use of radio waves to control an object wirelessly when he sailed his 47-in- (1.2-m-) long metal boat in a tank. Tesla sent radio signals to make the boat turn and switch its electric motor on and off.

Inside of Tesla's remote-controlled boat



One of four batteries that supplied power to the boat.

Electric motor powered gears, which turned the boat's propeller screw to move the boat forward.

Steering motor received signals from radio receiver to turn the boat's rudder to steer.

1898

Discovery of noble gases

British chemists William Ramsay and Morris Travers discovered three chemical elements: krypton, neon, and xenon. All three are noble gases, which have no color or smell and are mostly inert, which means they rarely react with other substances.



Neon gas glows when electricity passes through it, as in these colorful lights.